

For them, FI started with the idea of having more time to spend together and with their kids rather than working ten- to eleven-hour days (plus commutes) to pay daycares, schools, and nannies to raise their kids for them. In Jay's words, "we don't want to quit work just for the sake of quitting work. We want a lifestyle change because the life we created for ourselves is way too hectic and [is] not sustainable."

Justin, who writes the blog *Root of Good*, puts it this way: "I think when you're starting out on the path to financial independence, it's really abstract . . . I take it for granted (now) because I've been retired for over three years . . . We're living like the billionaires of the industrial era. Obviously, we're not real billionaires, but we have the freedom and flexibility to really have a lot of latitude in what we do every day."

Gwen, author of the blog *Fiery Millennials*, adopted the principles of FI early in life, even before graduating college. She said, FI "gives me options which I really appreciate. It just gives me the freedom and the flexibility to do basically whatever [I] want in the future."

Tanja Hester, who retired in her late thirties while living near beautiful Lake Tahoe, writes the blog *Our Next Life*. She makes an